



AJAI SAHNI



“ The objective of all initiatives has not been to address terrorism but to contain the political fallout of the Mumbai attack.

You can't derive lessons of Mumbai until you do a minute-to-minute analysis of the response of the agencies involved.

You can never have peace through peace processes. You can only have peace if you know the realities of war.

Need a protracted war model and keep up attacks on the Pakistan Army and ISI over a long period if we need peace.

The FBI has a budget of \$7.2bn, while we have a Rs 10-crore budget with nine people who sit without an office. ”

VED MARWAH

“ The Government is trying to shift criticism from the main issue by creating an agency that will not get cooperation.

The police and other agencies responded to 26/11 as if they were shooting for a Bollywood film.



There is lack of everything—training, coordination, equipment and accountability.

The step of briefing the media was hijacked by everyone. The army and navy jumped into the fray, creating confusion.

The political class should be persuaded to unite in this war against terror, instead of scoring political points. ”

involve this 1.3-million-strong police force you need charismatic political leadership and not invisible bureaucratic occupation. These home secretaries are occupiers. They are not leaders but are controlling police budgets, postings and transfers and it is they who are taking the courage out of the police leadership. The police leadership today is quiet, is crying, is helpless and is weak and leaderless. **Brahma Chellaney:** There hasn't been any change in Indian thinking and policies since the Mumbai attacks. India is facing a war which is escalating politically and quantitatively and we are still at the discussion stage. Even at the highest level of the Government there is this desire to discuss this issue but not to take hard decisions. So, unfortunately we are discussing things like surgical strikes, but between inaction and surgical strikes lie a hundred different economic, political and diplomatic options, none of which we have exercised till today.

In the mid-1990s, Australia—a country surrounded by oceans—began a counter-terrorism doctrine. Japan doesn't have terrorism but has a similar doctrine. India, not only does not have a counter-terror doctrine, no effort is even underway to formulate one. Since Independence we have not formulated or even tried to define a defence policy. If you don't have fundamentals like this, how do we sit round a table and discuss concrete steps, because we can't recreate the way the simple things that every country does.

Every counter-terror strategy has to be founded on a well thought out doctrine, effective state instruments to implement and effective deterrent structure, including thorough national laws that can mete out deterrent punishment to terrorists and lastly, the political resolve to stay the course. We need to put our minds together and come up with a working document on what to do with Pakistan overtly and covertly.

For full transcript of the discussion, visit:
www.indiatoday.in/war

